

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Import Data using Transform Maps

Date	31 January 2025	Team ID	6ab61594fa5e5219dc387253
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps	Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorming & Idea Prioritization: Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages team members to participate in creative thinking and problem solving. For this project, the session focuses on improving ServiceNow employee-training data imports, reference resolution, user roles, and ACL-based access control.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Bring together the project team and define the central problem that the brainstorming session will address.

Project Description	ServiceNow project implementing data import, dot-walking, user roles, and ACL-based access control to securely manage employee training records.
Target User	ServiceNow System Administrator / HR Operations team responsible for employee training imports, Transform Maps, reference fields, and field security.
Problem Statement	How might we import employee training data accurately into ServiceNow, resolve manager and department references through dot-walking, and protect sensitive training records using appropriate user roles and ACLs?
Desired Outcome	Reliable imports without duplicate records, correct reference relationships, and controlled access to sensitive employee training information.

User Perspective — Empathy Map

THINK & FEEL	Worries about duplicate users, inaccurate mappings, and unauthorized access to employee training scores.
HEAR	Leadership requires role-based access control. HR Operations reports missing IDs and inconsistent course names.
SEE	Raw CSV files with non-standard IDs and manual entry processes that create errors in training tracking.
SAY & DO	Manually verifies staging records, configures field-level ACLs, and writes onBefore transform scripts for validation.
PAIN	Duplicate training entries, broken reference linkages, and unauthorized visibility of confidential scores.
GAIN	Accurate automated imports, dynamic manager/department resolution, and strong role-based data security.

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Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Generate multiple possible solutions first, then group related ideas into technical themes.

Cluster	Idea	Description
Data Ingestion & Deduplication	Single Coalesce Key	Use employee ID as a Transform Map Coalesce field to identify existing records.
Data Ingestion & Deduplication	Compound Coalesce	Use employee ID together with course code so one employee can have multiple course records without unwanted duplicates.
Data Ingestion & Deduplication	Duplicate Prevention Script	Use an onBefore transform script to stop an insert when a matching record already exists.
Reference & Dot-Walking	Native Reference Mapping	Map the employee reference to the sys_user table using an appropriate display value.
Reference & Dot-Walking	Dynamic Dot-Walking	Resolve assigned_to.manager and assigned_to.department dynamically from the employee reference.
Reference & Dot-Walking	Scripted Reference Lookup	Use a sys_user lookup when standard reference matching is insufficient.
Roles & ACL Governance	Table-Level ACL	Restrict access to the employee training table to users with the required application role.
Roles & ACL Governance	Field-Level Score ACL	Protect the sensitive score field with dedicated Read and Write ACL rules.
Roles & ACL Governance	Dynamic ACL	Use ACL logic to check whether the logged-in user is authorized through the employee/manager relationship.
Automation & Error Handling	Scheduled Import	Use a Scheduled Import Set for recurring employee training CSV imports.
Automation & Error Handling	Error Notification	Trigger an event and notification when a Transform Map produces more errors than the defined threshold.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Compare the ideas using feasibility and importance/impact, then identify the ideas to carry into the implementation plan.

Priority Area	Idea	Reason for Placement	Implementation Focus
High Importance / High Feasibility	Compound Coalesce	Directly addresses duplicate records and is practical to configure in a Transform Map.	Coalesce employee ID + course code.
High Importance / High Feasibility	Dynamic Dot-Walking	Directly addresses manager and department reference resolution.	Use assigned_to.manager and assigned_to.department.
High Importance / High Feasibility	Field-Level ACL	Directly protects sensitive employee training scores.	Apply Read/Write ACLs to the score field.
High Importance / Lower Feasibility	Dynamic ACL Script	Provides relationship-based access control but requires additional scripting and testing.	Validate manager/employee relationship in ACL logic.
High Importance / Lower Feasibility	Automated Error Notification	Improves monitoring but requires event and notification configuration.	Trigger notification after a defined transform error threshold.
Lower Importance / High Feasibility	Single Coalesce / Native Mapping	Simple approaches but provide less coverage for the complete project requirements.	Use where the source data is sufficiently standardized.
Lower Importance / Lower Feasibility	Complex Purging / SFTP Integration	Adds complexity beyond the immediate core import, reference, and access-control problem.	Keep outside the initial implementation scope.

Final Implementation Roadmap	1. Configure Transform Map Coalesce 2. Configure reference mapping and dot-walking 3. Create user roles and table/field ACLs 4. Test staging and transformed records 5. Validate access and error handling
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